

Blake C. Hoarty

EDUCATION

North Carolina State University

PhD, Economics

Expected graduation: May 2027

George Mason University

MA, Economics

May 2020

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

BA, Public Policy

December 2016

BA, Political Science

December 2016

WORK EXPERIENCE

PhD Student – Department of Economics

North Carolina State University

August 2022-present

High School Mathematics Tutor

Self-employed

November 2023-present

Economist – Consumer Price Index

United States Bureau of Labor Statistics

March 2020-July 2022

MA Fellow

Mercatus Center at George Mason University

August 2018-May 2020

Research Assistant

Cato Institute

June 2017-July 2018

Research Intern

Cato Institute

January 2017-April 2017

RESEARCH FIELDS

Agricultural Economics, Bayesian Econometrics, Microeconomics

JOB MARKET PAPER

“A Sequential Stochastic Approach to Rationalizing Hedging Decisions in Agricultural Markets,” with Jeffrey H. Dorfman

Abstract: Farmers have historically hedged much less of their corn production than economists recommended. Previous research has mostly modeled farmer behavior by employing the mean-variance hedge ratio in a 2-period investment setting. In this paper, we eschew this approach and use expected utility theory to rationalize hedging decisions made by farmers in a dynamic setting. We enable our representative farmer to make hedging decisions on a weekly basis to account for incremental changes in prior market beliefs. We operationalize farmer uncertainty through both Gaussian and non-Gaussian distributions. We find that subjective prior beliefs - especially prior mean and risk aversion, play a significant role in hedging decisions for all distributions tested. Other factors such as initial wealth play little to no role in optimal hedging decisions. Our results indicate that the heterogeneous hedging behavior of farmers can be fully rationalized through our expected utility framework.

WORKING PAPERS

“The Evolving Nature of Seasonality in Meat Demand,” with Barry Goodwin and Jeffrey H. Dorfman

“Moment Based Prior Sensitivity Analysis in High Dimensional Bayesian Econometric Models,” with Sujit Ghosh and Jeffrey Dorfman

“Optimally Combining Information Sources to Estimate the Federal Poverty Guidelines: Robustness and Red Flags,” with Jeffrey H. Dorfman, Peibin Hou, Wenying Li and Falin Sun

PEER REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

“On regulation and excess reserves: The case of Basel III,” with S.M. Miller, *Journal of Financial Research* (Vol. 44, No. 2): 215-247, March 2021 [\(Link\)](#)

“Licensing massage therapists in the name of crime: the case of Harper v Lindsay,” with D. Deyo, C. Norris and E. Timmons, *Journal of Entrepreneurship and Public Policy* (Vol. 10, No. 1): February 2021 [\(Link\)](#)

“PPI and CPI seasonal adjustment during the COVID-19 pandemic,” with S. Muri et al., *Monthly Labor Review*, U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, May 2022 [\(Link\)](#)

NON-PEER REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

“Who Participates? An Analysis of School Participation Decisions in Two Voucher Programs in the United States,” with C. DeAngelis, *Cato Institute Policy Analysis no. 848*, September 2018 [\(Link\)](#)

EXTENSION WORK

"Is There A Future for Tobacco Farming?" with Jeffrey H. Dorfman and Younghyeon Jeon

INSTRUCTIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Instructor (Instructor of Record):

North Carolina State University

EC 202: Principles of Macroeconomics, Spring 2024, Spring 2026

ARE 201: Introduction to Agricultural and Resource Economics, Spring 2025

Teaching Assistant:

North Carolina State University:

EC 202: Principles of Macroeconomics, Fall 2022

EC 202: Principles of Macroeconomics, Spring 2023

EC 202: Principles of Macroeconomics, Fall 2023

Tutor:

George Mason University:

ECON612: Microeconomics II (graduate), Fall 2019

ECON630: Mathematical Economics I (graduate), Fall 2019

North Carolina State University:

EC 201: Principles of Economics Summer 2023

EC 202: Principles of Macroeconomics, Summer 2023

EC 205: Principles of Microeconomics, Summer 2023

ARE 201: Introduction to Agricultural and Resource Economics, Summer 2023

PRESENTATIONS

"On regulation and excess reserves: The case of Basel III," *Western Economic Association International 94th Annual Conference, San Francisco, CA, June 30th, 2019*

"Mitigating the Effects of the COVID-19 Pandemic on Seasonally Adjusted Price Indexes," *American Statistical Association's 4th Seasonal Adjustment Practitioners' Workshop 2022, June 8th, 2022*

"A Sequential Stochastic Approach to Rationalizing Hedging Decisions in Agricultural Markets," *Agricultural and Applied Economics Association 2026 Annual Meeting, July 27th, 2026*

"The Evolving Nature of Seasonality in Meat Demand," *Agricultural and Applied Economics Association 2026 Annual Meeting, July 27th, 2026*

SCHOLARSHIPS, HONORS AND AWARDS

University Graduate Fellowship – North Carolina State University

One year \$4000 award that provides competitive recruiting supplements to new doctoral students

MA Fellowship – Mercatus Center at George Mason University

Competitive, fully funded scholarship including a monthly research stipend

TECHNICAL STRENGTHS

Stata, R, SAS, SQL, MATLAB, LaTeX